

Growing Chicory from Seed: A Comprehensive Guide

Discover the art of cultivating chicory, a versatile plant with a rich history and numerous uses. From its Civil War roots to modern medicinal applications, chicory offers both beauty and benefits to any garden.

Order the Medicinal Garden Kit



Historical Significance and Uses

1

Civil War Era

Chicory became a popular coffee substitute when supplies ran short.

2

Traditional Medicine

Native Americans valued chicory root for its medicinal properties.

3

Modern Research

Studies show chicory contains compounds with anti-inflammatory and prebiotic properties.



Getting Started with Chicory Seeds

1 **Timing is Crucial**

Start seeds indoors 4-6 weeks before last frost for summer harvest.

2 **Direct Sowing**

Sow outdoors in mid to late summer for fall and winter harvests.

3 **Seed Viability**

Chicory seeds remain viable for 4-5 years when stored properly.

Soil Preparation and Planting

Soil Requirements

Well-draining soil with pH 6.0-6.8. Work in organic matter for fertility.

Direct Sowing

Create shallow furrows 1/4 inch deep. Space rows 18-24 inches apart.

Seedling Care

Thin seedlings to 6-8 inches apart when they reach 2-3 inches tall.

Container Growing

Pot Selection

Choose deep containers at least 12 inches deep and wide.

Potting Mix

Use high-quality mix enriched with compost. Avoid garden soil.

Container Care

Water frequently. Ensure 6 hours of sunlight daily.



Ongoing Care and Maintenance

Watering

Keep soil consistently moist. Mulch to retain moisture.

Fertilization

Apply balanced organic fertilizer monthly. Avoid excess nitrogen.

Pest Management

Watch for slugs and snails. Use organic deterrents if needed.





Harvesting for Medicinal Use

1

Timing

Harvest roots in fall or early winter when compounds are concentrated.

2

Digging

Carefully dig to preserve the entire taproot.

3

Processing

Clean roots gently. Use fresh or dry for later use.

4

Storage

Store dried roots in airtight containers in a cool, dark place.



Conclusion: The Versatility of Chicory

Culinary Delight

Enjoy chicory's bitter greens in salads or as a coffee substitute.

Medicinal Potential

Explore chicory's traditional and modern health applications.

Garden Beauty

Appreciate the striking blue flowers in your landscape.